

Swimming – Pathfinder Honor (Level 3 Equivalent)



Purpose of the Swimming Honor

The Swimming Honor teaches water safety, confidence in deep water, proper swimming techniques, and survival skills. It helps prevent drowning and prepares Pathfinders to enjoy water activities safely.

1. Water Entry Skills

a. Feet-First Entry (Jump Entry)

Enter the water by jumping feet-first from the side of a pool or dock

Arms crossed or holding nose if needed

Used when water depth is unknown or for safety

b. Head-First Entry (Sitting Position)

Sit on pool edge, hands extended forward

Lean forward and slide smoothly into water

Used only in water at least 9 feet deep

c. Head-First Entry (Kneeling Position)

Kneel at pool edge

Hands extend forward, head between arms

Push gently forward into deep water (9 feet or more)

 Safety Note: Head-first entries must never be done in shallow or unknown water.

2. Breath Control and Submerging

a. Bobbing Toward Safety

Submerge head, exhale underwater

Push up, inhale, move forward

Repeat at least 5 times in chest-deep water

Used to move safely when tired

b. Rotary Breathing

Turn head to the side to breathe

Used mainly in front crawl

Demonstrate at least 10 times

Helps maintain rhythm and endurance

3. Buoyancy Skills

a. Survival Float (Front Float)

Face down, arms and legs spread

Relax body and float

Hold position for at least 30 seconds in deep water

Used to rest and conserve energy

b. Back Float

Roll onto back from vertical position

Ears in water, face upward

Hold for at least 30 seconds

Allows breathing while resting

4. Changing Positions in Deep Water

a. Vertical to Horizontal (Front)

From standing or treading position

Extend arms forward

Lean forward into front float

b. Vertical to Horizontal (Back)

Lean backward slowly

Spread arms and legs

Maintain balance and breathing

5. Treading Water

Keep head above water

Use arms and legs together

Can use scissor kick, egg-beater, or flutter kick

Demonstrate for at least 30 seconds in deep water

Important for survival when unable to swim to safety

6. Front Swimming Skills

a. Streamline Push-Off with Flutter Kick

Push off wall with arms extended

Body straight and tight

Kick for 3–5 body lengths

b. Streamline Push-Off with Dolphin Kick

Legs move together like a dolphin tail

Strong core movement

Demonstrate for 3–5 body lengths

c. Front Crawl (Freestyle)

Alternate arm strokes

Flutter kick

Rotary breathing

Swim at least 15 yards with good technique

7. Back Swimming Skills

Elementary Backstroke

Face up

Arms move together in a scooping motion

Whip kick (frog kick)

Smooth and relaxed breathing

Swim at least 15 yards

8. Side Swimming Skills

Side Scissors Kick

Body on side

Top leg moves forward, bottom leg backward

Legs snap together like scissors

Used in lifesaving and rescue swimming

Swim at least 10 yards

9. Water Safety Skills

a. Reach or Throw — Don't Go

Reach with pole, towel, or stick

Throw rope, bottle, or floating object

Never enter water unless trained

b. Cold Water Safety

Cold water causes shock and loss of strength

Enter slowly if necessary

Wear life jackets in cold conditions

Think before going near cold water or ice

Importance of Swimming Skills

Prevents drowning

Builds confidence

Improves fitness

Enables safe participation in water activities

Prepares Pathfinders to help others

Pathfinder Values Learned

Discipline

Safety awareness

Self-control

Responsibility for self and others

